

Purpose: To encourage us to follow Paul’s example and be faithful witnesses of Jesus Christ even in the midst of trials and tribulation. †1. Introduction and Timeline for Acts 21-28

1. Paul reports on his journeys and faces an angry mob in Jerusalem.

- Read [Acts 21:1—22:21](#) †2. David Rolph Seeley and Jo Ann H. Seeley

“After three successful missionary journeys that took him through the Roman empire, Paul returned to Jerusalem, though he knew it was dangerous to do so.” (*Lesson Manual*) (See [Acts 20:16](#).)

- Acts 21:1-14. Warned of Agabus, Paul said, “I am ready ... to die at Jerusalem for the name of the Lord Jesus.”
- Acts 21:17-19. “And when we were come to Jerusalem, the brethren received us gladly.”

Missionaries “report their mission experiences to the stake president and high council and often to ward or branch members in sacrament meeting.” (*Lesson Manual*)

How have you benefited from hearing about others’ missionary experiences?

- Acts 21:20-25. Paul is asked to receive ritual cleansing in the temple to demonstrate his observance of the law.
- Acts 21:26-30. “Jews which were of Asia, when they saw him in the temple, stirred up all the people”.
- Acts 21:31-36. “... and when they saw the chief captain and the soldiers, they left beating of Paul.”
- Acts 21:37—22:21. The captain allowed Paul to speak to the mob.

How did this show Paul’s courage?

In Acts 21-28, begin a list of ways when Paul showed courage in being a witness of Jesus Christ.

When have you borne your testimony in a situation that required courage?

How did you gain the courage to do this?

2. Paul is taken before the Sanhedrin.

- Read [Acts 22:22—23:35](#).

- Acts 22:22-30. The temple crowd said, “Away with such a fellow ... it is not fit that he should live.”
- Acts 23:1-10. Paul to the Sanhedrin, “I have lived in all good conscience before God ...” (Compare [D&C 135:4](#).)

How do you think Paul’s “good conscience before God” helped him at this time?

Consider what practices you may need to change to have a “good conscience before God.”

- Acts 23:11. That night “the Lord ... said, Be of good cheer, Paul ... so must thou bear witness also in Rome.”
- Acts 23:12-21. Some “Jews banded together ... saying that they would neither eat nor drink till they had killed Paul.”
- Acts 23:22-35. Paul is escorted to Caesarea by 200 soldiers, 70 cavalymen, and 200 spearmen. (See verse 23.)

“This was the third time in just a few days that Paul was protected from death.” (*Lesson Manual*)

3. Paul testifies to Agrippa, but his testimony is rejected.

- Read [Acts 26](#). †3. Acts 24-25 Summary

- [Acts 26:2-29](#). “I think myself happy, king Agrippa, because I shall answer for myself this day”.

What might have kept Agrippa from becoming a Christian?

What attitudes or other problems keep people today from accepting the gospel of Jesus Christ?

“Although Agrippa found Paul’s message almost believable while Festus rejected it outright, both failed the test of faith Paul offered them.” (*Lesson Manual*) †4. Elder L. Tom Perry

4. Paul is shipwrecked on his way to Rome.

- Read [Acts 27-28](#).

- Acts 27:7-20. “Sirs, I perceive that this voyage will be with hurt and much damage, not only of the lading and ship”.
- Why do some of us occasionally disregard our Prophet’s counsel? (See verses 11-12.)

- Acts 27:21-16. Paul said, “Sirs, ye should have hearkened unto me ... [but] there shall be no loss of any man’s life”.

How have you learned the importance of following his counsel?

- Acts 27:27-44. Paul’s prophecy is fulfilled.
- Acts 28:7-9. Paul “laid his hands on him, and healed him... others also ... came, and were healed”.
- Acts 28:16-31. “And when we came to Rome ... there came many ... to whom he expounded and testified”.

What can we learn from Paul about being a faithful witness of Jesus Christ? †5. Paul’s End

Next Week: L39 “For the Perfecting of the Saints”; See L39: [Class Member Study Guide](#).

Read the Institute New Testament Student Manual at: [New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212](#).) † •

NT38 Quotes

†1. **Introduction and Timeline for Acts 21-28:** "... On his return to Jerusalem he was arrested and sent to Caesarea (Acts 21:17–23:35), where he remained a prisoner for two years (Acts 24:1–26:32), and was then sent for trial to Rome, suffering shipwreck on the way (Acts 27:1–28:10). He remained in Rome two years (Acts 28:30) and was then released. He then appears to have visited Asia, Macedonia, Crete, and perhaps Spain. At the end of about four years he was again taken a prisoner to Rome and suffered martyrdom, probably in the spring of A.D. 65." (Bible Dictionary, [Paul](#))

†2. **David Rolph Seeley and Jo Ann H. Seeley:** "The Prophet Joseph Smith must have felt a deep kinship with the Apostle Paul. Both began their service to the Lord through a life-changing vision. Both were true to the vision they received and acted with unrelenting faith and courage to fulfill their missions, bearing testimony to a skeptical world (see [JS—H 1:24–25](#)). And both sealed their testimonies with their blood as witnesses to the gospel they had so fervently preached throughout their lives.

...
"The Prophet Joseph Smith even gave us a physical description of the Apostle Paul: "He is about five feet high; very dark hair; dark complexion; dark skin; large Roman nose; sharp face; small black eyes, penetrating as eternity; round shoulders; a whining voice, except when elevated, and then it almost resembled the roaring of a lion" (*Teachings of the Prophet Joseph Smith*, sel. Joseph Fielding Smith [1976], 180)... ("Paul: Untiring Witness of Christ," *Ensign*, August 1999)

†3. **Acts 24-25 Summary:** "Paul was sent to Felix, the governor, and testified boldly before him. Paul remained a prisoner for two years while Felix hoped to receive money to free him. When Felix was succeeded as governor by Festus, the Jews asked Festus to send Paul to Jerusalem for trial. Paul refused to go, knowing he would not get a fair trial there. Instead, Paul appealed to Caesar, as was his right as a Roman citizen. Festus agreed to send Paul to Rome, but Paul first had to appear before Herod Agrippa, a Roman-appointed ruler." (*LM*)

†4. **Elder L. Tom Perry:** "There are a number of things that we can do—that you can do—to advance an understanding of the Church. If we do it with the same spirit and if we conduct ourselves in the same way we do when we host a temple open house, our friends and our neighbors will come to understand us better. Their suspicions will evaporate, negative stereotypes will disappear, and they will begin to understand the Church as it really is.

"Let me suggest a few ideas of what we can do.

"First, we must be bold in our declaration of Jesus Christ. We want others to know that we believe He is the central figure in all human history. His life and teachings are the heart of the Bible and the other books we consider to be holy scripture. The Old Testament sets the stage for Christ's mortal ministry. The New Testament describes His mortal ministry. The Book of Mormon gives us a second witness of His mortal ministry... Only through Jesus Christ is salvation possible. This is why we believe He is the central figure in all human history. Our eternal destiny is always in His hands. It is a glorious thing to believe in Him and accept Him as our Savior, our Lord, and our Master...

"Second, be righteous examples to others. ... follow the counsel given to us in [1 Timothy 4:12](#): "But be thou an example of the believers, in word, in conversation, in charity, in spirit, in faith, in purity." ...

"Next, speak up about the Church. In the course of our everyday lives, we are blessed with many opportunities to share our beliefs with others. When our professional and personal associates inquire about our religious beliefs, they are inviting us to share who we are and what we believe. They may or may not be interested in the Church, but they are interested in getting to know us at a deeper level.

"... Your associates are not inviting you to teach, preach, expound, or exhort. Engage them in a two-way conversation—share something about your religious beliefs but also ask them about their beliefs. Gauge the level of interest by the questions they ask. If they are asking a lot of questions, focus the conversation on answering those questions. Always remember that it is better for them to ask than for you to tell." ("Perfect Love Casteth Out Fear," Conference address, October 2011.)

†5. **Paul's End:** "Historians assume that Paul died a martyr's death in Rome about A.D. 65. Throughout his life, he fulfilled his responsibility as an Apostle to "go ye therefore, and teach all nations" (Matthew 28:19). He also fulfilled the Lord's prophecy that he would preach the gospel "before the Gentiles, and kings, and the children of Israel" (Acts 9:15). He was a faithful witness of Christ despite verbal and physical attacks, unjust imprisonment, and natural disasters." (*Lesson Manual*)

Recommended Reading or Videos:

1. [NT38 Enrichment.pdf](#) contains more quotes and links to articles, blogs, and talks.
2. *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, [Chapter 34: Acts 21-28](#).
3. Video—[Paul: A Chosen Vessel](#) (11:24)

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